

8.7 Unemployed Population (Unemployment)

The unemployed population refers to individuals who were not engaged in any economic activity during the reference period but were actively seeking employment and have taken steps to find employment in the preceding four weeks and are willing to accept a job if one becomes available within the next two weeks. According to Table 8.9 out of the total labour force 491,709 were unemployed of that 232,671 (47.3%) are males and 259,038 (52.7%) are females.

Table 8.9 : Unemployed Population by Sector and Sex, 2024

Sector	Unemployed Population					
	Total	%	Male	%	Female	%
Total	491,709	100.0	232,671	47.3	259,038	52.7
Urban	88,307	100.0	43,342	49.1	44,965	50.9
Estate - Urban	263	100.0	151	57.4	112	42.6
Rural	374,233	100.0	175,144	46.8	199,089	53.2
Estate - Rural	28,906	100.0	14,034	48.6	14,872	51.4

As shown in Figure 8.11, the 20–24 age group has the highest number of unemployed people, with 135,538 individuals. The 25–29 age group follows with 90,055 people. Except for the 15–19, 20–24, age groups, there are more unemployed women than men in all other age categories.

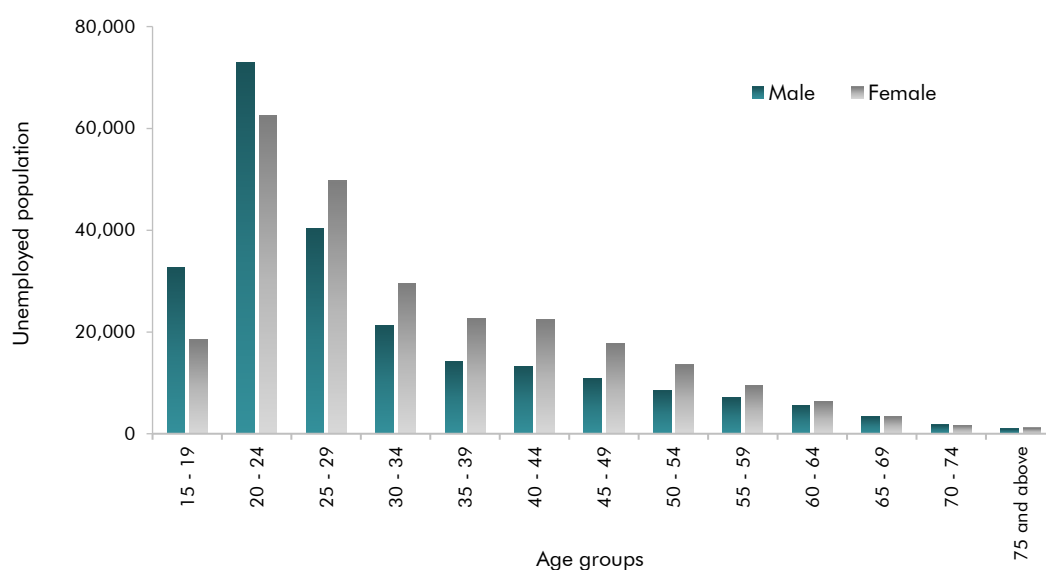


Figure 8.11 : Unemployed Population, by Age Group and Sex, 2024

8.8 Employment Rate and Unemployment Rate

According to Table 8.10, during the reference period, the employment rate in Sri Lanka was reported at 94 percent. At the district level, the highest employment rate was reported in Moneragala District at 96.1 percent, while the lowest was reported in Batticaloa district at 89.9 percent. During the same period, the unemployment rate in Sri Lanka was 6 percent. Examining the district-level data, the highest unemployment rate was observed in Batticaloa district at 10.1 percent, whereas the lowest was reported in Moneragala District at 3.9 percent.